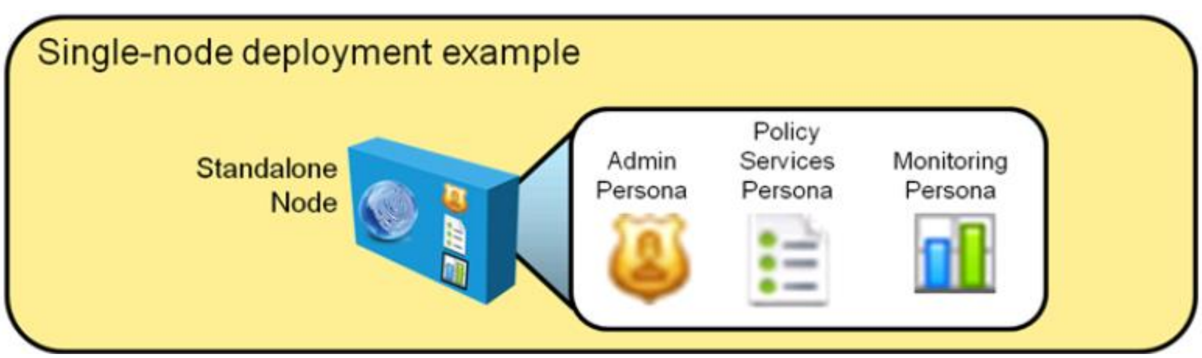
Cisco ISE Deployment Options:

- Implementing Cisco ISE, you should be aware of the Deployment Modes.
- Implementing Cisco ISE, you should be aware of architectural functionality.
- Cisco ISE is a highly flexible and scalable security platform.
- Cisco ISE is platform designed for fault tolerance and redundancy.
- There are mainly two deployment options Standalone and Distributed.
- Node is Individual instance – Physical Appliance or Virtual Appliance.
- Node refer to a physical or virtual instance of the Cisco ISE appliance.
- Persona is often used interchangeable and determines the service.
- Persona or personas of a node determine the services provided by a node.
- Example of Personas are Administration, Policy Service and Monitoring etc.
- ISE node can assume the Administration, Policy Service, or Monitoring personas.
- Role is applies to Administration and Monitoring nodes.
- Standalone Node is not aware of each other and acts alone.

Standalone Deployment:

- Standalone Deployment is built on one ISE Node.
- Standalone mode is also called as Single Node Deployment.
- In this deployment, all ISE personas reside on a single appliance.
- All the personas are available in Single Physical or Virtual ISE device.
- Single ISE device is responsible for performing all the functions.
- Standalone Deployment method is no redundancy available.
- If ISE loses network connectivity authentication/authorization will not work.
- If ISE device loses power connectivity authentication/authorization will not work.
- Maximum number of device supported around 10000 depends upon the device.
- This method is not used commonly as it does not have redundancy.
- This deployment is recommended only when testing a solution in a lab.



Distributed Deployment:

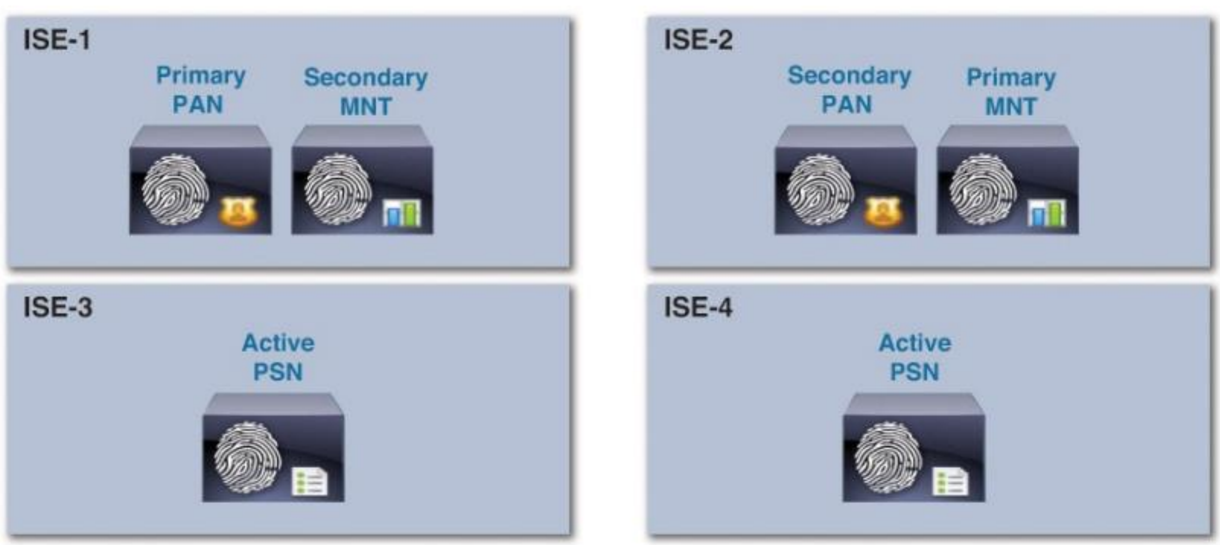
- Distributed Deployment is built with more than one ISE nodes.
- This Method is also called as Two Node Deployment Mode.
- This method, all the personas are divided and assigned into two persona.
- This method provides redundancy as using two ISE devices.
- The first appliance, ISE-1, acts as the primary PAN and secondary MNT.
- The second appliance, ISE-2, acts as the secondary PAN and primary MNT.
- Both the first and second appliances, ISE-1 and ISE-2, simultaneously act as PSNs.
- Maximum number of device supported around 10000 depends upon the device.
- This method is commonly used to implemented and deployed.

Example of two-node deployment.

Four Node Deployment:

- Four Node Method is also same as Two Node Method.
- However, Four Node Method using four ISE devices in the deployment.
- The first appliance, ISE-1, acts as the primary PAN and secondary MNT.
- The second appliance, ISE-2, acts as the secondary PAN and primary MNT.
- ISE-3 and ISE-4 in four-node deployment are used strictly for the PSN persona.
- Maximum number of device supported around 10000 depends upon the device.

Example of four-node deployment.



Fully Distributed Deployment:

- Each & every persona will be allocated to two or more separate ISE devices.
- Fully distributed deployment of Cisco ISE separates each persona.
- Fully distributed deployment places each on a separate appliance.
- Place the primary PAN on ISE-1 and the primary MNT on ISE-2.
- Secondary PANs and MNTs would be deployed on ISE-3 and ISE-4.
- Fully distributed deployment model has greater scalability.